City of Cambridge

COF 2026-120
FIRST IN COUNCIL
September 28, 2026

Dear Honorable Mayor Siddiqui and Councillors,

Attached you will find the Legislative Update which includes Pending Home Rule Petition Report, List of Committee Referrals, and Pending Zoning Petitions and Municipal Ordinances Chart.
I am available should you have questions.

Best,

Paula Crane
Interim City Clerk

A true copy;

ATTEST:-

Paula M. Crane,
Interim City Clerk

City of Cambridge

A communication was received from Interim City Clerk Paula Crane, regarding an update regarding legislative activity.

PENDING HOME RULE PETITIONS UPDATE – SEPTEMBER 28, 2026

HD 4706, An Act Requiring That Broker Fees in the City of Cambridge be Paid by the Party Who Solicits a Licensed Broker was filed by Representative Connolly. House - Referred to the Committee on Housing May 15, 2025. Senate – Senate concurred May 19, 2025. Joint – Hearing scheduled for November 19, 2025 from 11:00AM-5:00PM in Gardner Auditorium. House – Reported by committee to Clerk's Office for processing, will accompany a study order. House – Accompanied a study order, see H5352 (under House Rule 27) April 13, 2026. For legislative history: https://malegislature.gov/Bills/194/HD4706

HD 4735, An Act Further Regulating Procurements By The City of Cambridge, adopted by the City Council on March 24, 2025, was filed by Representative Decker on May 21, 2025. House – Referred to the Committee on Municipalities and Regional Government May 27, 2025. Senate – Senate concurred May 29, 2025. Joint – Hearing scheduled for June 24, 2025 from 1:00PM-5:00PM in B-1. House – Bill reported favorably by committee and referred to the committee on Housing Steering, Policy and Scheduling July 16, 2025. House – Committee reported that the matter be placed in the Orders of the Day for the next sitting August 14, 2025. House – Rules suspended August 14, 2025. House – Read second and ordered to a third reading August 14, 2025. For legislative history: https://malegislature.gov/Bills/194/HD4735

H.3924, An Act expanding the definition of dependent for the purposes of municipal employee benefits as to the City of Cambridge. This legislation was filed by Representative Decker. House - Referred to the Committee on Public Service on March 20, 2025. Senate – Senate concurred December 15, 2025. Joint – Hearing scheduled for January 27, 2026 from 1:00PM-5:00PM in B-1 January 17, 2026. Joint – Hearing rescheduled to January 27, 2026 from 1:00PM-1:15PM in B-1 and Virtual January 27, 2026. House – Bill reported favorably by committee and referred to the committee on House Steering Policy and Scheduling April 2, 2026. House – Committee reported that the matter be placed in the Orders of the Day for the next sitting April 23, 2026. House – Rules suspended April 23, 2026. House – Read second and ordered to a third reading April 23, 2026. For legislative history: https://malegislature.gov/Bills/194/HD4279

2026-2027 COMMITTEE REFERRAL LIST
(As of 9/24/2026)

Civic Unity Committee

That the Government Operations, Rules & Claims Committee and the Civic Unity Committee hold a joint meeting as soon as possible to discuss the topic of including foreign policy resolutions in regular City Council meetings. POR 2026-101 of May 11, 2026.

Economic Development & University Relations Committee

That the City Manager is requested to work with relevant City departments to develop a plan for inclusive and robust engagement on any proposed licensing changes, and to ensure that the City's licensing framework remains as efficient, accessible, and streamlined as the law allows, without imposing unnecessary barriers or burdens on licensees. POR 2026-124 of June 22, 2026.

That the City Manager is requested to evaluate the impacts of the temporary extended last call and public outdoor drinking district measures during the authorization period, consult with the License Commission, Cambridge Police Department, and other relevant stakeholders on the feasibility and desirability of making these measures permanent, and identify any necessary changes or actions required for implementation beyond the current authorization. POR 2026-130 of June 22, 2026.

Government Operations, Rules & Claims Committee

That the Government Operations, Rules & Claims Committee and the Civic Unity Committee hold a joint meeting as soon as possible to discuss the topic of including foreign policy resolutions in regular City Council meetings. POR 2026-101 of May 11, 2026.

Housing Committee

That the City Manager is requested to direct the Community Development Department, and other relevant City departments, to examine and report back to the City Council with a feasibility analysis with findings, options, and recommendations regarding the following proposed amendments to the multifamily zoning ordinance. POR 2026-123 of June 8, 2026.

Ordinance Committee

A communication transmitted from Yi-An Huang, City Manager, relative to Awaiting Report Item Number 24-26, regarding clarification on the Wage Theft Ordinance. CMA 2024 #196 of September 9, 2024.

A communication transmitted from Yi-An Huang, City Manager, relative to potential alternative methods of curb cut review. CMA 2026-214 of August 3, 2026.

Public Safety Committee

A communication transmitted from Yi-An Huang, City Manager, relative to the Police Review & Advisory Board Quarterly Report for the period of Fall 2025 through the First Quarter of 2026. CMA 2026-85 of April 13, 2026.

Transportation & Public Utilities Committee

A communication transmitted from Yi-An Huang, City Manager, relative to Awaiting Report 26-07 regarding restrictions to eligibility for on-street resident parking. CMA 2026-202 of June 22, 2026.

9/24/26

PENDING ZONING PETITIONS AND MUNICIPAL ORDINANCES CHART

	In City Council	**Referred to Ordinance Committee**	**Ordinance First Hearing Date & Date Published**	**Passed to a 2nd Reading & Date Published**	**Planning Board Hearing**	**Date Rpt. Rec'd** (at least (21 days before ordination date)	**Expiration Date (if applicable)/Comments**
A communication transmitted from the City Manager, relative to Awaiting Report Item Number 24-26, regarding clarification of the Wage Theft Ordinance. CMA 2024 #196. **Municipal**	September 9, 2024	September 9, 2024			**N/A**	**N/A**	**N/A**
A communication transmitted from the City Manager, relative to potential alternative methods of curb cut review **CMA 2026-214** **Municipal**	August 3, 2026	August 3, 2026					